



"Pipoca and the Castle of Dreams" is more than a bedtime story – it is a journey. Through a poetic narrative, it explores, with lightness and depth, the symbolic territory of childhood sleep – a space of transition between reality and imagination, between childhood and development.

Pipoca's journey begins like so many childhood nights: with reluctance, games and an invitation to rest. But when he falls asleep, he plunges into a dream world in which symbolic figures and fantastic situations make up an archetypal narrative.

The story dialogues with different mythical and philosophical traditions. By following an ethereal fox through a dark tunnel, Pipoca approaches the myth of Orpheus, who descends into the underworld in search of Eurydice. Like Orpheus, Pipoca is guided by a figure who represents the link with the known world. The soft music that initially attracts him – and which soon becomes chaos and noise – is reminiscent of Orpheus's lyre: a hypnotic call that opens paths but guarantees no return.

Pipoca's dreamlike journey also echoes Alice in Wonderland, whose fall down the rabbit hole leads her to a world of abrupt physical transformations, where size, shape, and logic falter. Like Alice, Pipoca transforms – literally – throughout his journey. His wings emerge not as a symbol of absolute power, but as a response to fear, loss, and the unknown.

In this process, the tunnel he traverses represents the underworld – the place of shadows, confusion, and confrontation with what is strange and threatening. It is a space for dissolving the previous form and preparing for something new. Upon emerging from the tunnel, already transformed, Pipoca faces a new danger: an erupting volcano. The transition does not grant him immediate peace, but rather places him before a new stage of his journey.

The book also evokes Plato's allegory of the Cave, when it treats sleep as a space of limited and illusory perception. Like prisoners who mistake shadows for reality, Pipoca lives intensely in the world of dreams – until, upon waking, everything seems distant and irreversible. Childhood, in this sense, is our first cave: where we learn to discern what we see, feel and believe.

The mythological references extend to the setting: Hypnos, the Greek god of sleep, is reimagined as the king of a castle on the banks of the river of oblivion, in a direct allusion to the dreamlike geography of Greek myths. His guardian, the dragon Morpheus – the name of the god of dreams – represents both danger and dormant wisdom, and carries with it the classic notion that even the most powerful being has a weak spot.

In the end, Pipoca is still dreaming... His adventure is a rite of passage in the form of a dream: comical, poetic, frightening and liberating. And as with the most striking dreams, perhaps he will remember everything – or perhaps it will all evaporate with the first rays of sunlight. But something remains: the crossing made, and the silent certainty that there is much more to us than we imagine.